



清华大学
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Definition



- **Group:** defined as two or more individuals, interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives
- Groups can be either formal or informal

Social Identity Theory



- **Social identity theory:** considers when and why individuals consider themselves members of groups

Group Properties #1



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- **Role:** a set of expected behavior patterns attributed to someone occupying a given position in a social unit
 - **Role perception**
 - **Role expectations**

Group Properties #1



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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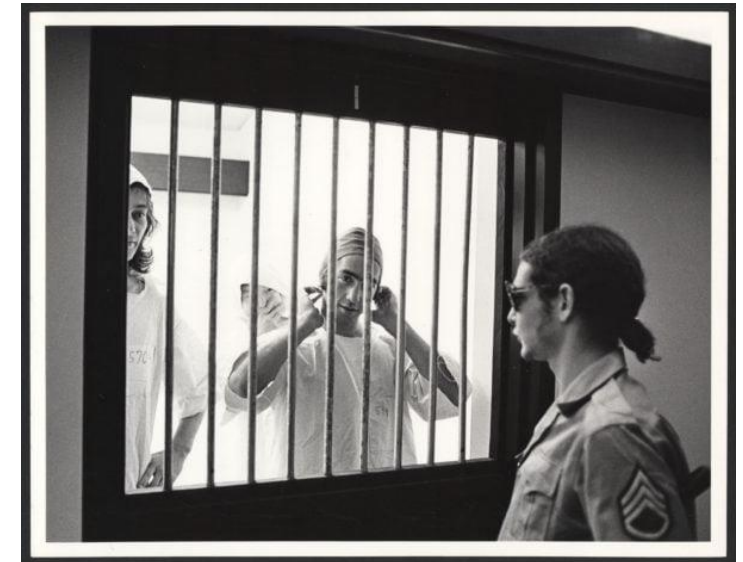
- **Role conflict:** situation in which an individual faces divergent role expectations

Group Properties #1



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- **Role Play and Assimilation**
 - Philip Zimbardo's prison experiment



Group Properties #2



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- **Norms:**
 - Acceptable standards of behavior within a group that are shared by the group's members



Group Properties #2



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- Asch's Conformity Experiment



Group Properties #2



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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Group Properties #2



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- **Positive norms and group outcomes**
 - If employees aligned their thinking with positive norms (e.g., reciprocity; helping), these norms would become stronger and the probability of positive impact would grow exponentially
 - Positive group norms may well beget positive outcomes, but only if other factors are present



Group Properties #3



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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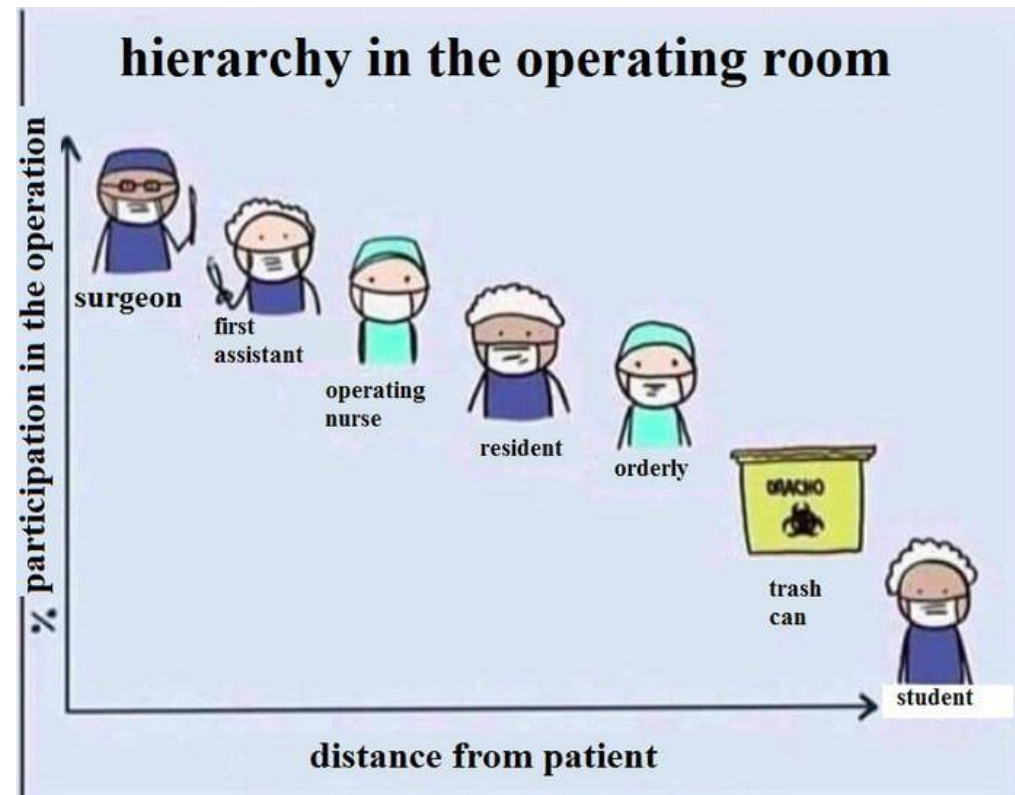
- **Status:** a socially defined position or rank given to groups or group members by others

Group Properties #3



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- Is a status hierarchy necessary for team functioning?



Group Properties #4



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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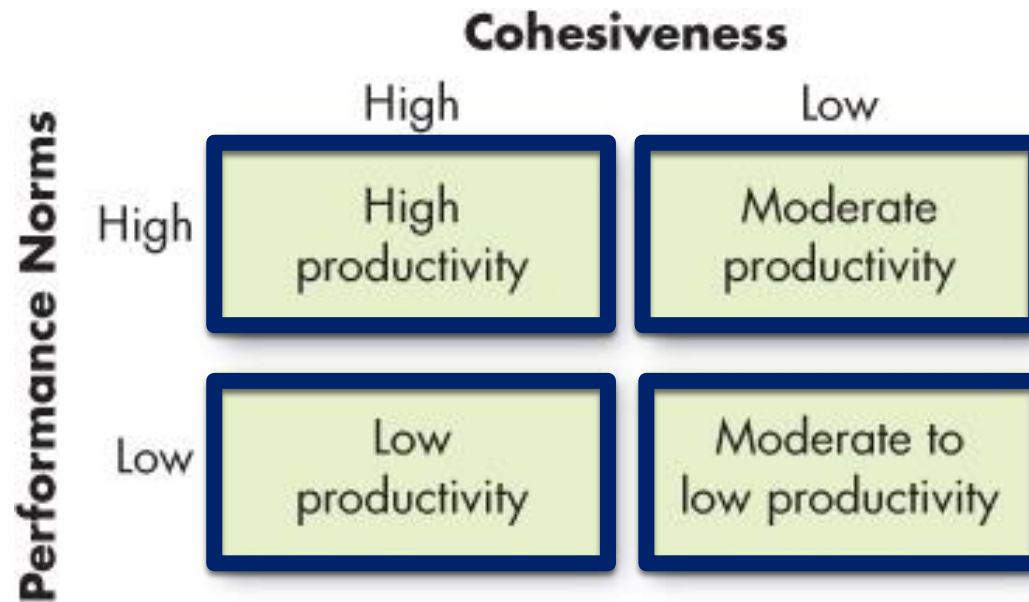
- Group size affects the group's overall behavior.
- **Social loafing**: the tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than alone.

Group Properties #5



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- **Cohesiveness:** the degree to which members are attracted to each other and motivated to stay in the group; relational concerns



Group Properties #6



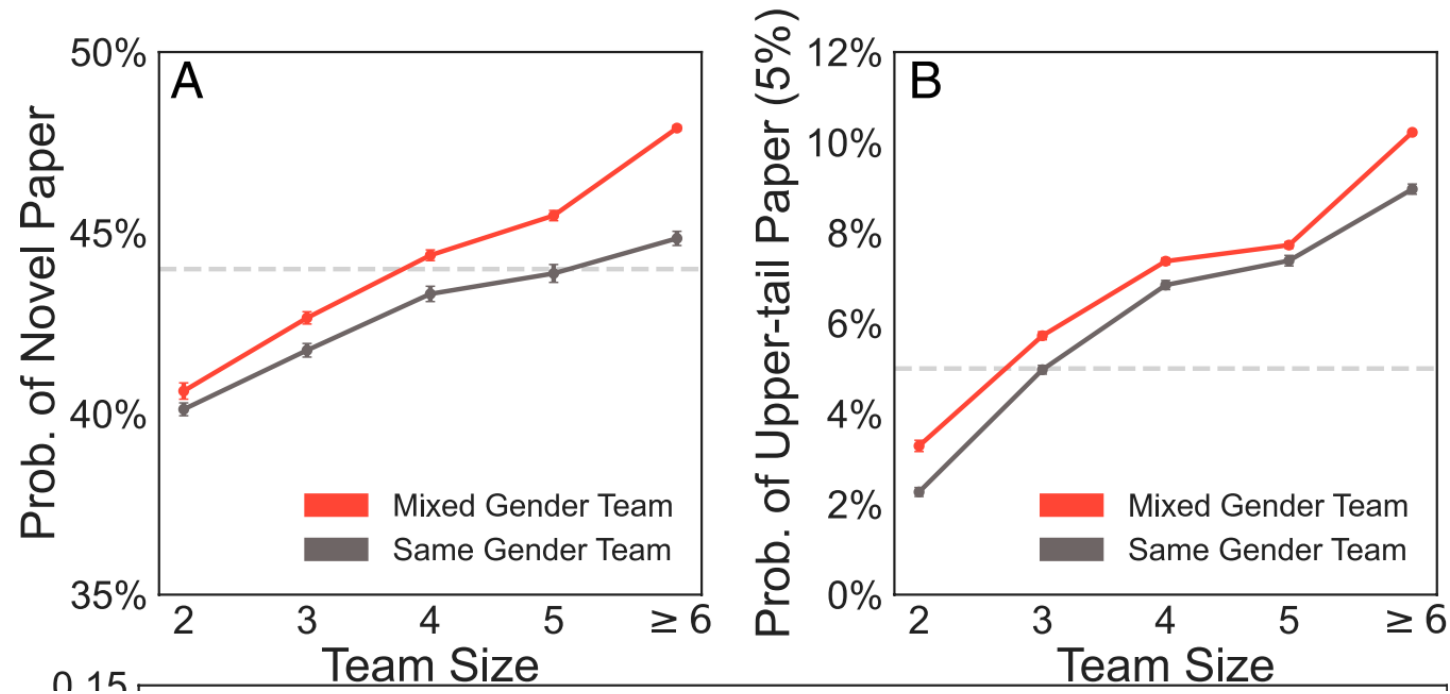
Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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- **Diversity:** degree to which members of the group are similar to, or different from, one another.

Group Properties #6



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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Mixed-gender teams generate **more novel** and **higher-impact** ideas than single-gender teams.

Diversity influences group outcomes

Group Properties #6



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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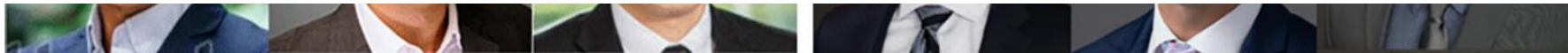
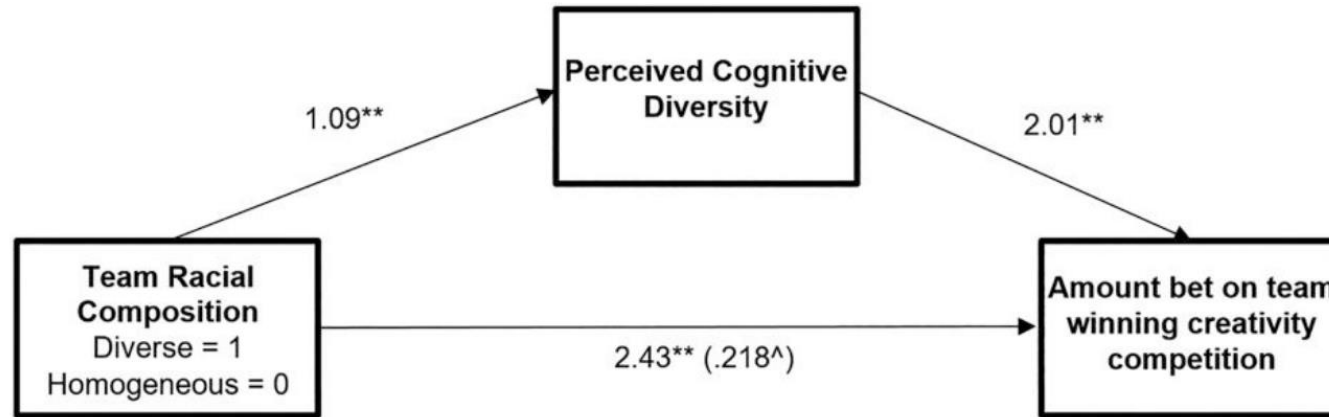
Group Properties #6



Roles	Norms	Status	Size	Cohesiveness	Diversity
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Figure 4. Mediation Model (Study 2)



Diversity also influences how observers judge the team performance!

Group Decision Making



We look to others
for relevant
information about
situations



We conform to
peer pressure

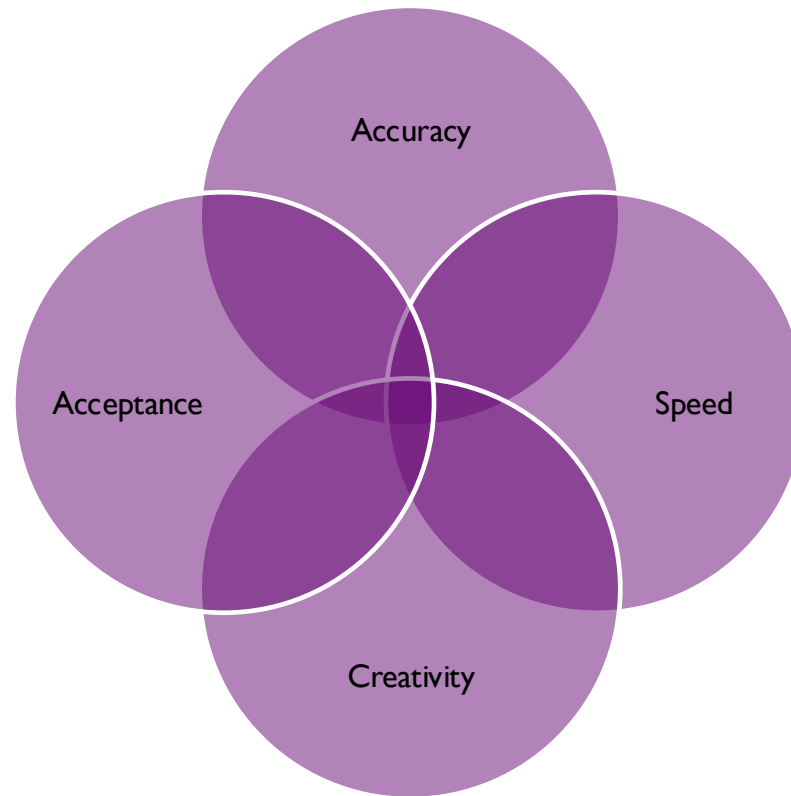
Group Decision Making



- Strengths of group decision making:
- Weaknesses of group decision making:



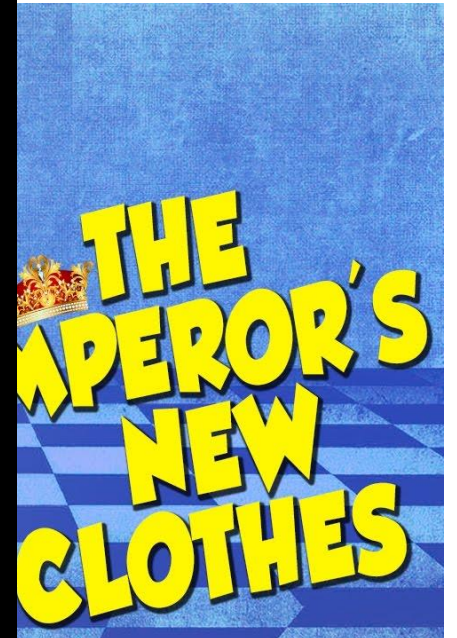
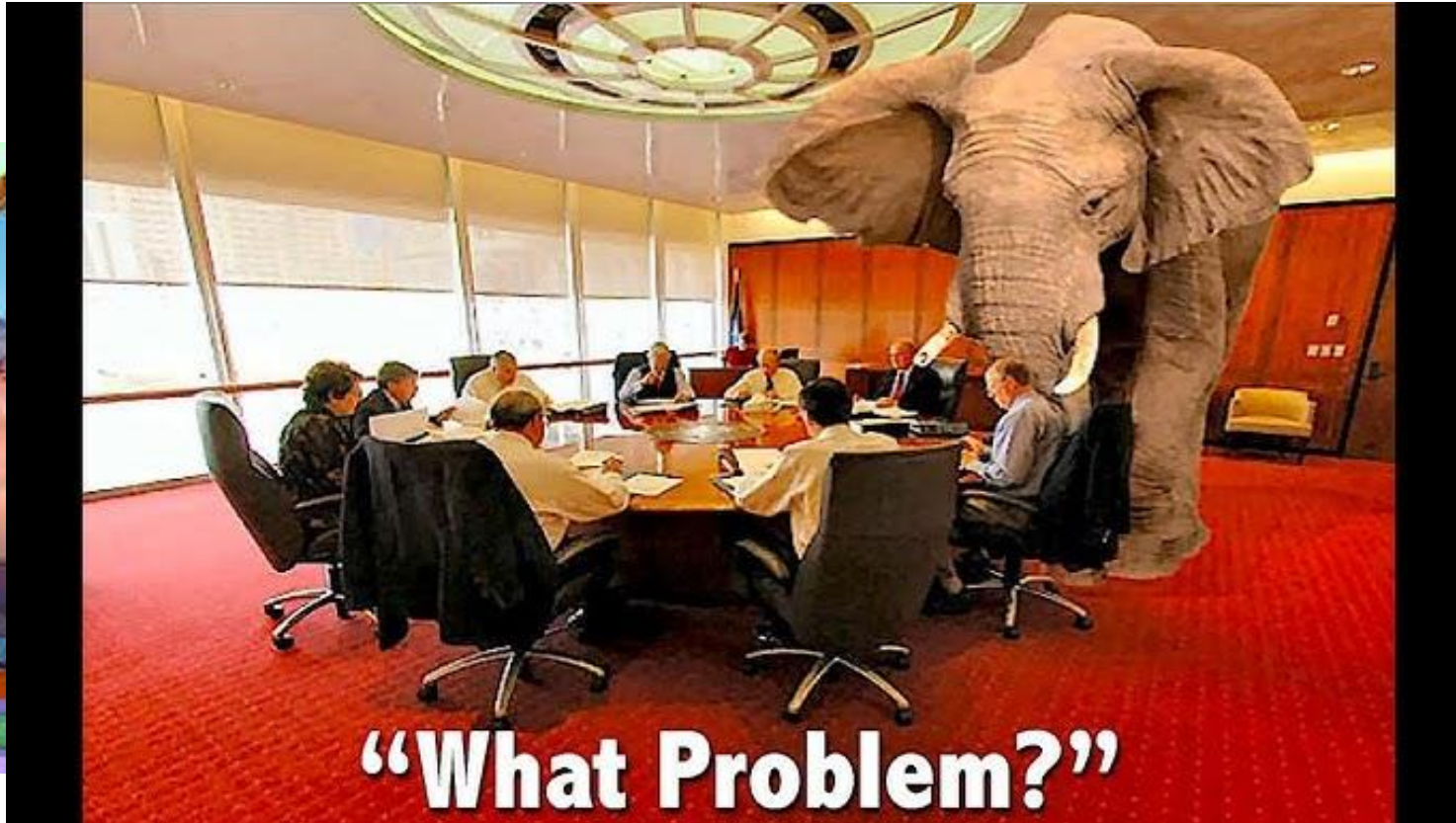
Effectiveness and efficiency of group decisions:



Diffusion of Responsibility



“Our meetings were taking place in a curious atmosphere of assumed consensus, not one spoke against it”



- Groupthink is a phenomenon that occurs when a group of individuals reaches a consensus *without* critical reasoning or evaluation of the consequences or alternatives
- Occurs when members want to avoid conflicts
- Can be very damaging to organizational productivity and outcomes

Groupthink: Challenger Disaster



- On Jan 28th 1996, Space Shuttle Challenger broke apart 73 seconds after launch (all 7 crew members were killed)
- Cause: O-ring failure on the right solid rocket booster; The O-rings were known to perform poorly in cold temperatures
 - It was 28° F (-2.222° C) that morning



Groupthink: Challenger Disaster



Engineers at Morton Thiokol (the O-ring manufacturer) strongly warned NASA not to launch in cold weather

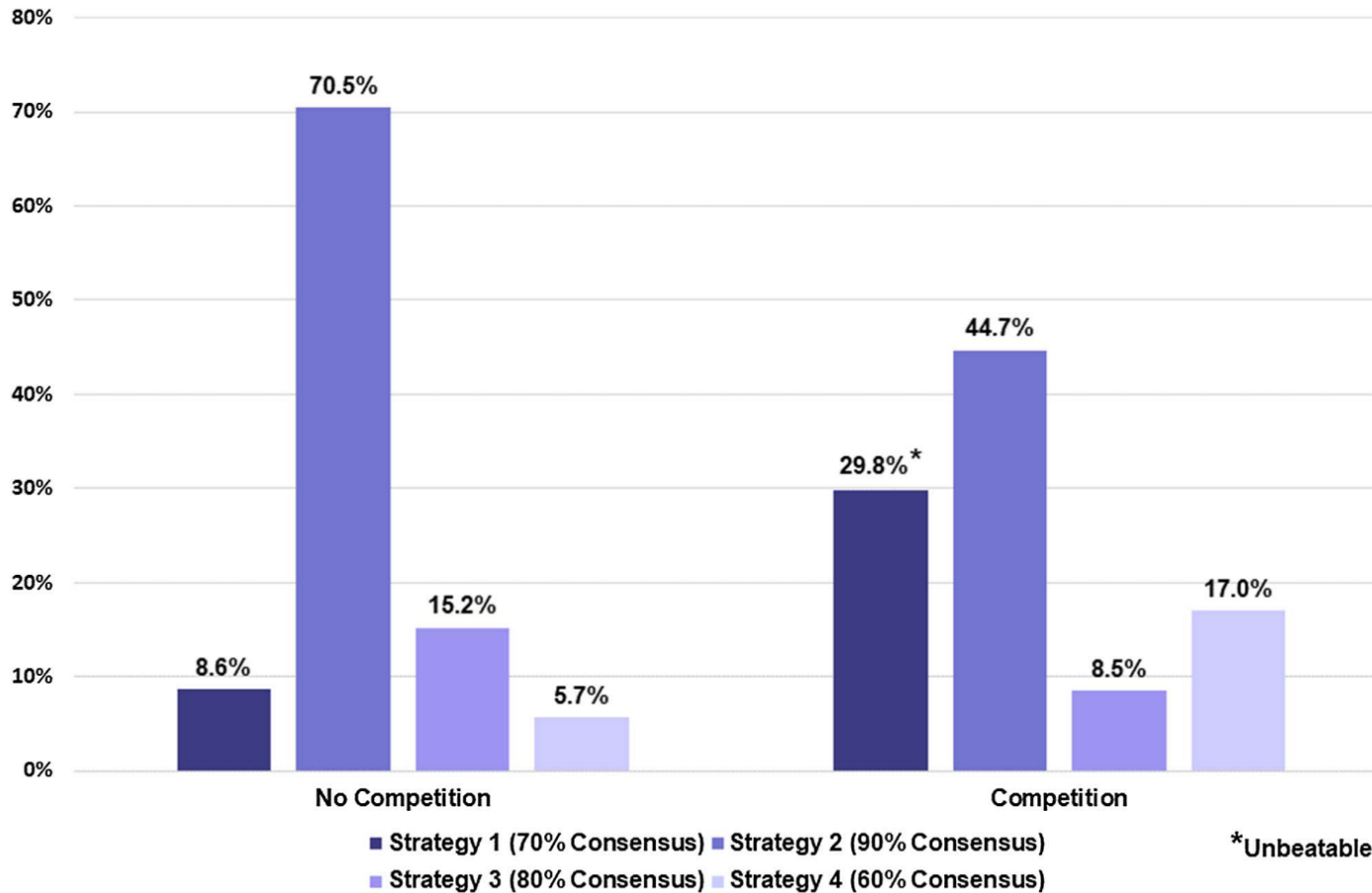
NASA managers pushed back, as they were under enormous pressure to launch on schedule

One NASA manager famously said: *My God, Thiokol, when do you want me to launch — next April?*

Engineer Roger Boisjoly presented data showing O-ring damage in previous cold-weather launches

Thiokol managers ultimately overruled Roger's suggestion

Allure of Consensus



It's a natural tendency for human to seek for consensus, especially when there is no conflict of interest

Social Loafing



- A phenomenon in which individuals put into *less* efforts when working and being judged in teams
- How to prevent social loafing?
 - **Identifiability:** Individual contributions visible or hidden
 - **Fairness:** Perceived fairness reduces loafing
 - **Dispensability:** members who feel unnecessary do more social loafing





Collective Effort Model

- Reanalysis of over 300,000 swimming performances (relay vs. individual events)
- Comparison of individual performance vs. relay performance across positions (1st to 4th)
- **Clear evidence for effort losses at early relay positions:**
 - First swimmers often show reduced effort compared to individual races
- **Significant effort gains at later positions (3rd, 4th):**
 - Swimmers in final positions typically outperform their individual race times

Positive Illusions



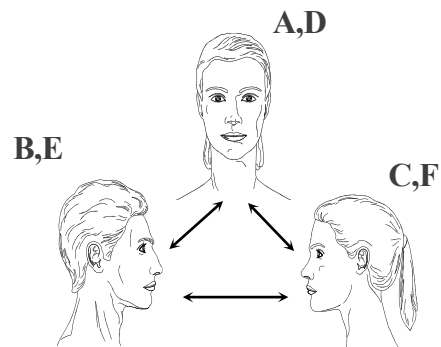
- Groups tend to develop even more (!!) positive illusions after performing tasks.
- Why?

Common Information Bias

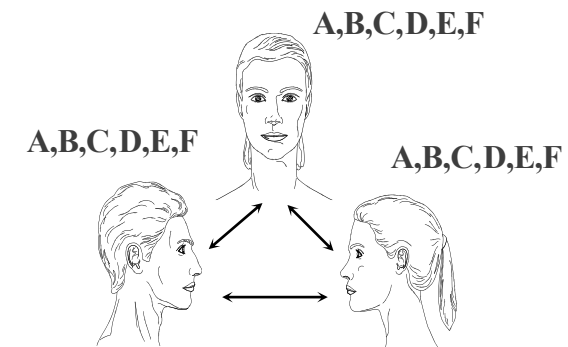
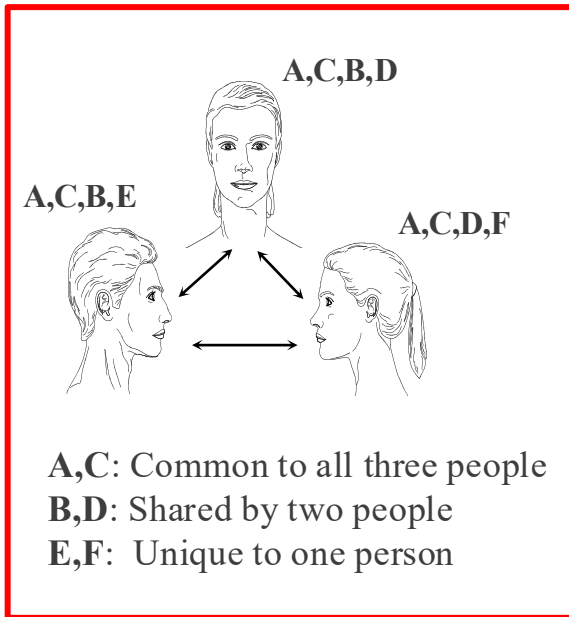


- **Common information bias:** Groups spend the majority of their time discussing information that they all have in common

Information can be distributed differently in teams



No overlap of information
between three people



All information fully-shared
by all three people.

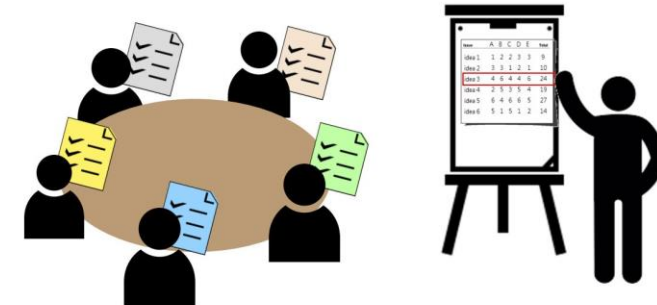


- **Brainstorming** can overcome pressures for conformity.
 - In a brainstorming session:
 - The group leader states the problem.
 - Members then “free-wheel” as many alternatives as they can.
 - No criticism is allowed.
 - One idea stimulates others, and group members are encouraged to “think the unusual.”

Technique #2



- **Nominal group technique:** restricts discussion or interpersonal communication during the decision making process.
 - Group members are all physically present, but members operate independently.
 - Permits the group to meet formally but does not restrict independent thinking, as does the interacting group.
- **Nominal groups outperform brainstorming groups.**



Technique #2

- Steps for a nominal group:
 - Each member independently writes down his/her ideas on the problem.
 - After this silent period, each member presents one idea to the group.
 - The ideas are discussed for clarity.
 - Each group member rank-orders the ideas.
 - The idea with the highest aggregate ranking determines the final decision.

